

- Why do I think I'm unable to reach my financial goals? What barriers are in my way and are they 100 per cent impossible to overcome?
- How was money introduced to me as a child? Was I taught to fear it or embrace it?
- Did I have any role models who displayed good money behaviour? Is there someone I look up to now who displays those behaviours? Could I invite them out for a coffee to chat about this?

Step #2: Lay down those 5 bricks

It doesn't feel like the most glamorous way to start building wealth, but looking back and understanding where our money is coming from and where it's going is essential.

We cover the 5 bricks in [chapter 3](#), and they're a good way to make sure you're not building your investments on shaky ground.

This is the hardest step for investors in training, as you'll see investing itself isn't so difficult; it's facing your money and potentially your financial flaws that we don't like. It's the equivalent of buying those super magnified bathroom mirrors that show you the blackheads you didn't know you had. We'd all prefer to not know.

But in order to become an investor, we need to know. Block out time in your calendar to sit down for two hours this week, or one hour over two weeks if you're time poor, to put all 5 bricks in place, so your investment portfolio has a solid foundation.

Journal prompt for step 2:

- Go to page 48 and complete the 5 steps listed there to establish your financial foundation.

Step #3: Work out your investing goals

We'd all love an extra \$100 000, but knowing why you want to grow your money puts more intention behind it. More intention leads to more action. Investors in training also know having a goal in mind prevents them from